



PROGRESS REPORT

Burundi: progress report, September 2025 – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-10 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

This report asks the same set of questions of every country. The rows below are a fixed frame of indicators, one row each, chosen in advance and covering all thirty-eight subjects the base tracks — so what appears here is decided by the frame and not by whichever records happened to accumulate. Each row says what happened on that indicator during the period, with every claim linked to the source it rests on.

Where a row reads *No evidence*, the base holds nothing on that indicator. **That is a statement about this base, not about the country** — it does not mean nothing exists, only that nothing has been collected here yet. The rows that carry evidence say what it is; the rows that do not are left to speak for themselves.

The period is 2025-09-01 to 2026-09-10.

Progress values. *Movement* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Movement, regulations still pending*.

Governance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Digital transformation strategy	The ten-year public-service digitalisation master plan is in force and its financing project was reviewed at mid-term in March 2026. The Plan directeur de digitalisation des services publics 2023-2033 was adopted in Council of Ministers on 10 May 2023 and is the country's standing digital transformation instrument. 2025-11 — a high-level workshop under the Prime Minister's patronage turned the plan into an implementation roadmap across administration digitalisation, connectivity, financial inclusion, innovation and cybersecurity. 2026-03 — the World Bank conducted a mid-term review of the project financing that work. What the base does not hold is any published progress measure against the plan: no service count, no target achieved, and no evaluation of the plan itself as distinct from the project funding it.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	ICT strategy	The national ICT policy ran to 2025 and has expired with no adopted successor; sector strategy is now to be written under a long-range vision instead. The Politique nationale de developpement des technologies de l'information et de la communication was adopted in Council of Ministers on 13 July 2011 for a term running to 2025. Its term has expired and no adopted successor was located. 2026-07-03 — the Prime Minister instructed ministries to produce implementation documents for the Vision 2040-2060, with public-administration digitalisation and e-government among the first priority programmes. That is now the mechanism by which sector ICT strategy is to be written, and it is a process rather than a strategy: no document, timetable or budget is published.	REGRESSED
Strategies, plans and policies	Broadband strategy	A national broadband strategy was validated in 2017 and never adopted, while a broadband mapping system was established in late 2025. Burundi Large Bande 2025 was drawn up with technical-union support and validated by stakeholders on 6 December 2017, and was still awaiting government adoption. No published full text and no adopting act were located, so a strategy named after a year that has now passed has never been in force. 2025-10-28 to 30 — a national event established a broadband mapping system under regulator stewardship, to identify underserved areas, direct investment and support an operational roadmap. Mapping where coverage is absent is the input a broadband strategy would use; the strategy it would feed is the one that has not been adopted.	MIXED a strategy still unadopted while a mapping system was built
Strategies, plans and policies	Data storage / cloud strategy	A sovereign cloud and data hubs are a pillar of the AI strategy, built around a planned data centre, with no build on record. A sovereign cloud and national data hubs are one of the six pillars of the April 2026 artificial-intelligence strategy, framed around the state technology agency's data centre. Nothing existed before it and nothing has been built since. The data centre itself is reported under data storage and remains a stated priority with no site or date. So the country has a cloud policy, a data governance strategy and a data protection statute, and no national facility for any of them to run on.	MOVEMENT a strategy pillar with no build behind it
Strategies, plans and policies	Data interoperability framework / roadmap	A cross-government information-systems concept was presented for validation in December 2024 as the route to adopting international ICT standards. 2024-12-17 — the state technology secretariat presented the final Concept type des systemes d'information des institutions publiques to stakeholders for validation, described as a foundation of digitalisation permitting the adoption of international ICT standards. What the record shows is presentation for validation, not formal adoption. No published text, adopting instrument, technical specification or compliance obligation on ministries is held, so the base can date the document and cannot say what it requires of any institution.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	AI strategy	A National AI Strategy for 2026 to 2030 was validated in April 2026 on six pillars, including a sovereign cloud and about fifteen health and agriculture pilots. 2026-04-22 — the strategy was validated on six pillars: governance and ethics, sovereign cloud and data hubs, education and research, innovation and incubators, human capital, and about fifteen health and agriculture pilots, and it was presented as the centre of the country's digital strategy. It sets a target of training more than a thousand officials. It follows a national readiness diagnostic run in November 2025. No implementing decree, budget line or first pilot has been reported since validation, and the compute the strategy assumes does not exist: no source on this ledger states any national computing capacity.	MOVEMENT
Strategies, plans and policies	Data localisation policies	A regional regulatory profile records no national framework on cross-border data transfers and no measure restricting them. The digital trade regulatory profile states that Burundi has no national legal framework on cross-border transfers of data and no measures restricting them, including on the location of data, local storage, bans on data transfers or local processing requirements. The finding is a stated absence rather than a gap in the record, which is the more useful of the two. Two caveats travel with it: the profile carries no printed publication date and its underlying regulatory survey runs only to December 2021, and the personal data protection law promulgated in March 2026 is an image-only scan, so whether it introduced a transfer or localisation rule cannot be read from the base.	NO CHANGE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data governance policy	A National Data Governance Strategy was validated in November 2025 on seven pillars, treating data as a public good. 2025-11-14 — a National Data Governance Strategy was validated on seven pillars, supported by the United Nations regional commission and aligned to the African Union data policy framework, treating data as a public good. None existed before it. Validation is not adoption: no decree, gazettal or implementing instrument appears on the ledger in the nine months since, and no institution is named as owning the strategy. The data protection law reported under legislation arrived two months later and is the only binding instrument on this ground.	MOVEMENT
Strategies, plans and policies	Open data policy	A draft access-to-information law was adopted in Council of Ministers on 10 June 2026; no open-data policy instrument is held. 2026-06-10 — the Council of Ministers adopted the draft law on access to public information, presented by the communication and media minister. It is a draft adopted in Council rather than a law in force: no text is published and no parliamentary date is set. Against it the base holds no national open-data policy or strategy. What exists is an operative licence rather than a policy: the statistics institute publishes an open licence governing reuse of the data on its own platform, which is an instrument of one institution and not a whole-of-government mandate.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	Data protection legislation	A personal data protection law was unanimously adopted on 15 January 2026: eight chapters, an independent authority and criminal penalties, where no statute existed. 2026-01-15 — the National Assembly unanimously adopted a personal data protection law with eight chapters, an independent supervisory authority and criminal penalties, aligned to the African Union convention, reported the following day as the country's first such statute. No statute existed before it. The sequencing is stated by the government itself: legislation came first in order to enable the biometric identity card, which is reported under digital identity and is technically ready but waiting on its own instrument. The authority the law creates is not on record as operating, reported below.	MOVEMENT
Legislation and regulation	Cybersecurity legislation	A stand-alone cybercrime statute has been in force since March 2022, with cybersecurity obligations carried in the 2024 communications code. Loi n 1/10 du 16 mars 2022 portant prevention et repression de la cybercriminalite is in force and recorded as such on the official legal database, and the base holds its complete promulgated text. The 2024 code des communications electroniques et postales carries cybersecurity obligations at articles 160 to 167 alongside it. Nothing moved on either in the window. What the base does not hold is any implementing regulation, any national cybersecurity strategy, or any published enforcement action under the 2022 statute.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Legislation covering digital id	A ministerial ordinance made identity-card registration of every SIM compulsory from 25 June 2026, while the identification file itself still awaits instituting texts. 2026-06 — the regulator required every subscriber to regularise SIM identification against the national identity card, with non-compliant lines deactivated from 25 June 2026, under a ministerial ordinance of 13 January 2026. It is the first instrument on the ledger to make the national identity card a condition of holding a service. Underneath it the register is not yet constituted: the official procedure page for the Fichier National d'Identification states that further texts remain to be adopted to institute the file. An obligation to identify against a register precedes the instrument establishing the register.	MOVEMENT
Legislation and regulation	Digital payments legislation	The 2018 payment-systems statute is the framework law; the central bank has since published an oversight framework and launched a national instant payment system. Loi n 1/07 du 11 mai 2018 portant systeme national de paiement is the framework statute, and the law the central bank cites for its power to regulate the issue and use of payment instruments; its articles 22 to 24 carry the move of payment instruments off paper and the admissibility of electronic and optical evidence. Every official copy located is an image-only scan. The central bank has published an oversight framework covering the real-time gross settlement system, the clearing house, the central securities depository, the national switch, instant payment systems and electronic money platforms, with a licensing, monitoring, inspection and sanction regime for payment service providers, and in April 2026 launched the national instant payment system under a regulation of its own.	MOVEMENT

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Legislation and regulation	Legislation enabling data interoperability	A 2018 presidential decree is the closest instrument to legislation enabling data sharing between public bodies; nothing moved on it. Decret n 100/085 du 25 juillet 2018 establishes the national framework for the collection, dissemination, access, archiving and security of data and micro-data. It defines administrative data as data collected by public institutions in the exercise of their functions, brings administrative data into the dissemination regime, and provides for making data available by electronic means, with institutional public users and rules on access. It is an enabling instrument rather than a mandate: it does not require any two public bodies to connect, and the base holds no implementing text, no data-sharing agreement made under it and no platform operating on its authority.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	AI legislation / regulations	No binding artificial-intelligence instrument was located in any national legal source; a non-binding strategy was validated in April 2026. No Burundian loi, decret, ordonnance ministerielle or regulator reglement governing artificial intelligence was located across the official legal database, the official gazette, the presidency, both chambers, the communications regulator and the state technology secretariat, on a search dated to the national readiness assessment held in Bujumbura on 25-27 November 2025. 2026-04-21 – a national validation session for the artificial-intelligence strategy was opened by the ministry responsible for the digital economy with a development agency. What moved is the validation of a non-binding strategy, not any instrument: the absence the indicator asks about is unchanged and is now dated.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	E-commerce legislation	There is no free-standing e-commerce statute; coverage sits in the 2024 communications code, under which the regulator made a conformity declaration compulsory in June 2026. There is no Burundian law on electronic commerce, electronic transactions or electronic signature; coverage is carried inside the 2024 code des communications électroniques et postales, whose article 1 applies to all transactions by electronic means, and the regulator treats that code as the legal basis for electronic commerce. 2026-05-29 – the regulator published guidelines for the national electronic-commerce sector setting technical, operational and organisational standards for interoperability, transparency, transaction security and online consumer protection. 2026-06-26 – it then made a prior conformity declaration compulsory for platforms and merchant sites operating in Burundi, which is the operative regulatory step. The guidelines themselves are an image-only scan, so what they require cannot be read from the base.	MOVEMENT
Legislation and regulation	Statistics legislation	Statistics legislation is a chain of three acts rather than a code, the 2021 recast being the most recent link with a machine-readable text. Loi n 1/08 du 20 mai 2021 recast the 2007 law organising the national statistical system, and is the substantive recast in a chain running from the 2007 statute through this one to a further modification of 24 July 2023 that the statistics institute cites as the governing law. No gazetted text of the 2023 modification was located, so the operative law can be named and its current wording cannot be read. Nothing moved on the statute in the window.	NO CHANGE

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Legislation and regulation	Access to information legislation	An access to information bill was listed on the National Assembly's order paper for the session opened on 3 August 2026, with no text published. 2026-08-04 — the bill was listed for examination in the session opened on 3 August 2026. No text, tabling number, sponsoring ministry or timetable has been published, and none existed before this listing. The session runs about three months under the constitution, which is the outer bound for passage in this sitting. Nothing else on this ledger touches access to information: there is no open data portal, no open data policy and no published dataset, so the bill would arrive into an absence rather than onto a practice.	MOVEMENT
Data protection	Data protection authority	The data protection authority was created by the January 2026 law, with no appointment, budget or decision on file since. The January 2026 data protection law provides for an independent supervisory authority. Seven months on, no appointment, budget, seat or decision appears on the record, so the body exists in statute and not in operation. That gap matters here more than usual. The biometric identity card, the digital civil registry and the instant payment system are all being built inside the same period, and the authority that would supervise their processing has not been constituted. The only consumer-facing enforcement on this ledger came from the telecommunications regulator instead, reported under payments consumer protection.	MOVEMENT
Data protection	National data protection readiness	A first personal data protection law was promulgated on 10 March 2026, replacing a position in which no legal regime for personal data existed. 2025-10-22 — the Council of Ministers adopted the draft law, recording the government's own position that the collection and processing of personal data in Burundi had no legal framework or regime at that date. 2026-01-15 — the National Assembly adopted the bill unanimously in plenary, the same account recording that the biometric national identity card process was under way in twelve pilot zones. 2026-03-10 — Loi n 1/03 was promulgated and published by the regulator on 18 March. The official text is an image-only scan with no text layer, so the base can state that a law exists and cannot yet state what it requires — including whether it carries any cross-border transfer or localisation rule. No supervisory authority, commencement date or implementing regulation is held.	MOVEMENT
Regional collaboration	Regional policy collaboration	Burundi joined the regional One Network Area and ratified the digital integration protocol, and agreed a continental trade implementation roadmap in August 2026. 2025-01-21 — the country joined the East African One Network Area and ratified the regional digital integration protocol, where neither applied before. 2026-08-03 — a technical team agreed during a continental trade secretariat mission to produce a country profile and implementation roadmap jointly owned by government and the private sector, tied by the minister to the country's African Union chairmanship, with the adjustment fund discussed as a financing route. No roadmap, profile or timetable has been published. 2026-07-28 — separately, a telecommunications-technology memorandum with Vietnam reached an implementation meeting, party to party rather than ministry to ministry, producing policy transfer, equipment and scholarships and no monetary commitment, against a memorandum signed in November 2024 with no digital follow-through reported.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Regional collaboration	Regional legal harmonisation	The regional assembly endorsed a bill creating an East African statistics bureau, with Burundian amendments; the bureau is not on record as established. 2025-10-10 — the East African Legislative Assembly endorsed the bill establishing a regional statistics bureau, carrying amendments from Burundi. Nothing existed before it and the bureau is not on record as constituted. It is the only regional legal instrument on this ledger that Burundi shaped rather than joined. The two others — the One Network Area and the digital integration protocol — were acceded to as drafted, and the cross-border data-sharing framework reported below was validated regionally with no national implementing instrument since.	MOVEMENT
Regional collaboration	Shared regional infrastructure	Submarine access runs through neighbouring countries with cross-border fibre interconnection, and a regional roaming framework is under development. The regulator's own indicators report brings the position together: submarine cable access to EASSy, SEACOM and TEAMS through neighbouring countries, national backbone cross-border interconnection points with Rwanda, the Democratic Republic of the Congo and Tanzania, and regional roaming. A landlocked country's international capacity is its neighbours' landings, and that is what this row records. 2026-05-25 to 29 — regional engagements opened development of a harmonised regional mobile roaming framework under the single digital market agenda, a framework-development milestone rather than an adopted tariff. 2026-06-23 to 24 — Burundi endorsed shared regional digital infrastructure, harmonised data-exchange frameworks and digital trust for interoperable cross-border public services at the regional development forum.	MOVEMENT
Regional collaboration	Cross-border data transfers	A regional secure data-sharing framework was validated in June 2026 under the East Africa digital integration project, with no national implementing instrument. 2026-06-25 — an East African cross-border secure data-sharing framework was validated under the regional digital integration project, where none existed before. No national implementing instrument is on file. The domestic law that would carry it is four months older — the January 2026 data protection statute — and its supervisory authority is not operating, so the country has agreed a regional transfer framework before constituting the body that would administer transfers under it.	MOVEMENT
Standards	National interoperability standards	Health standards were defined at a national workshop in April 2026 and the education system was assessed against continental norms in June; no cross-government standard is adopted. 2026-04-07 to 10 — a national health information workshop defined common technical standards, naming HL7 FHIR, with priority data-exchange flows and mediation for the country's fragmented health platforms. 2026-06 — Burundi self-assessed its education management information system against the continental EMIS norms and standards at a three-day technical workshop; no score or action plan is published. Both are sectoral. The cross-government instrument that would sit above them, the Concept type des systemes d'information des institutions publiques, was presented for validation in December 2024 and has not been adopted.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Standards	National quality standards	A national quality policy was adopted in February 2022, and the standards bureau signed a mutual-recognition protocol with a neighbour in August 2025. 2022-02-02 — the Council of Ministers adopted the Politique Nationale Qualite as the government's base instrument for establishing and supervising the national quality infrastructure system, setting its objectives, roadmap and timetable. The policy text itself is not held. 2025-08-29 — the standards and quality control bureau signed a memorandum with the Congolese control office covering exchange of information on standards and quality assurance, metrology, conformity assessment and pre- and post-shipment inspection, with progressive mutual recognition of conformity certificates. No official page carrying the protocol was located, so it is held through trade press.	MOVEMENT
Standards	Adoption of international standards	628 of 690 harmonised regional standards are adopted, 91 per cent, and the payment system migrated to ISO 20022 in February 2026. Burundi has adopted 628 of 690 harmonised East African standards and not adopted 62, a rate of 91 per cent and the highest of the six partner states, on a catalogue drawing on international standards among others. It is a first count with no earlier figure behind it, so the level is stated and the direction is not. 2026-02-05 — the central bank completed migration of the national automated transfer system to ISO 20022, with interbank operations resuming on the new system the following day, stated to ease integration with regional and international payment and settlement systems. It is the clearest instance on this ledger of an international standard being adopted into a working national system rather than into a catalogue.	MOVEMENT
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Non-governmental contribution to national policy	A consumer association called for a national convention on communications after denouncing service degradation, with no response from government or operators on file. 2026-07-31 — the consumer association denounced degradation of telecommunications service and proposed a national convention on communications. No convening date, government response or operator response is on file. It is the only non-governmental intervention in digital policy this ledger records. The same association is behind the tariff account reported under affordability, and the regulator's injunctions on value-added services followed its complaints — so the one civil-society actor visible in the record is a consumer body acting on billing rather than a research or advocacy sector engaging with strategy.	MOVEMENT
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Open discussion of government policy	Burundi hosted a regional internet governance forum for the first time in February 2026, against two decades of documented internet controls. A civil-society study mapping government internet controls from 1999 to 2019 records surveillance, restrictive media regulation, censorship of a named outlet and civil-society resistance. Its evidence base stops in 2019 and it is not a current snapshot. 2026-02-16 to 21 — Burundi hosted the Central Africa Internet Governance Forum for the first time, with eleven countries and government, youth, women, private-sector and technical participants, validating a 2026 regional roadmap. It is the clearest instance of open multi-stakeholder discussion of digital policy the base holds for the country. What it is not is evidence of domestic consultation on a domestic instrument: none of the strategies or laws in this chapter was published in draft for comment.	MIXED a first multi-stakeholder forum against two decades of documented controls

Finance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure	Sustainable domestic financing of digital transformation	The ICT ministry vote rose to BIF 131.7bn and BIF 16.0bn was proposed for the identity card, against 76.79% revenue realisation. 2026-05-13 — the settlement law put the communications and ICT ministry vote at BIF 131.7bn for 2024/25 against BIF 43.1bn the year before. The same instrument records whole-budget revenue realised at BIF 3,234bn, 76.79% of a revised target that had itself been cut from BIF 5,076bn to BIF 4,732bn. 2026-06-11 — BIF 16.0bn was proposed in the draft 2026/27 budget for the biometric identity card, the first domestic state digital line this base tracks for the country. A universal service fund appropriation of BIF 11.40bn was revised in for dedicated transit to health facilities and schools, on an own-source levy. The reason a voted line is not a spent line is on the record: a mid-year work plan showed credits shifted between programmes with a 2.7% overrun, and the 2026/27 budget was adopted with expenditure above BIF 7,020bn against revenue of BIF 6,296.03bn, with the audit court telling senators it lacked clarity on remaining public debt.	MIXED the ICT vote tripled and a first domestic identity line appeared while whole-budget revenue realisation fell short
MoUs and other agreements	Strategic relationships	A five-year health-sector memorandum with the United States commits US\$156m and covers health-data management. 2026-02-09 — a five-year agreement with the United States committing US\$156m to the health sector was signed, including health-data management. Nothing comparable existed before it and it is the largest single commitment on this ledger. What it does not carry is a data instrument. No data-sharing agreement under the memorandum has been published, so the terms on which health data would move between the two parties are not on the record — at a point when the country's data protection authority has not been constituted.	MOVEMENT
New investments	Mobilisation of non-state finance	Two co-financed rural connectivity contracts were signed, USD 10 million split 44:56 with an operator and USD 5,907,000 to serve 92 collines. 2025-12 — an operator was stated to have decided to double its investment to meet customer demand, with no absolute amount and no baseline published, so what that evidences is a commercial commitment rather than a measured sum. 2026-03-03 — a USD 10 million contract was signed to extend 4G broadband in rural areas, co-financed 44 per cent by government through the national project and 56 per cent by the operator. 2026-04-29 — a USD 5,907,000 contract was signed to serve 92 collines with no 2G or 3G coverage, benefiting 372,035 people including schools and health facilities. Both are the same instrument: public money buying commercial coverage where the commercial case does not stand on its own.	MOVEMENT
New investments	Development-partner project financing	The World Bank digital foundations project reached 61% commitment at its mid-term review, prioritising public-finance modernisation, the identity card and a data centre. 2026-03-27 — the mid-term review put commitment at 61%, with priorities named as public-finance modernisation, the national identity card and a national data centre, against a project already under implementation. It is the only development-partner digital financing on this ledger, and most of what moved in the window sits under it: the rural network contracts reported under mobile coverage, the mast programme, the broadband coverage target and the data centre that has not been built. No disbursement figure, results framework or restructuring is published, so commitment is the only measure available.	MOVEMENT

ICT Infrastructure

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile penetration	Two operators were contracted to build 4G on 178 hills, a third was licensed with no launch, and no national penetration figure exists. 2026-03-04 — one operator was contracted at more than US\$10m for 86 hills across 14 provinces, and 2026-05-04 — the incumbent for 92 hills at US\$5.9m, stated to cover 372,035 people, confirmed the following day. A mast-deployment programme under the same financing is named by the regulator as in train, addressing coverage rather than outages. 2026-03-02 — a third operator holds a licence granted in October 2025 with telecommunications and e-health plans and no service launch on file. An infrastructure-sharing law is named by the regulator as in draft, with no text, tabling date or sponsoring ministry published. No subscriber total, penetration rate or regulator return appears anywhere on this ledger, so coverage contracts are visible and take-up is not.	MOVEMENT on contracted coverage rather than on any measured subscriber base
Connectivity	Internet usage	12.5 per cent of Burundians were using the internet in early 2025, while a fifth-generation network launched commercially in December. The regulator's coverage figures put 3G at 50 to 54 per cent of the population, 4G at 32 to 34 per cent and 2G at 97 per cent, with only 12.5 per cent of Burundians actually using the internet in early 2025, against 80 installed fifth-generation sites after a commercial launch in December 2025. A separate account cites international union data that nearly 90 per cent of Burundians had no internet access in 2023. The regulator publishes a quarterly market observatory covering voice, SMS, internet and mobile financial services, its fourth-quarter 2025 edition appearing in April 2026 — the standing subscription-based series the indicator would be read from. Coverage and use are the gap this row records: a network reaching most of the population that most of the population does not use. An earlier and independent figure sits under that: 1.51 million internet users at the start of 2024, 11.3 per cent of the population and up 40,000 or 2.7 per cent on the year, against 7.78 million cellular mobile connections equal to 58.0 per cent of the population. The two counts use different methods and nothing reconciles them, but both put usage far below connection.	MOVEMENT on a low base
Connectivity	Mobile affordability	Internet package tariffs have more than doubled since January 2025, in some cases tripling, on the consumer association's account. 2026-07-31 — the consumer association reported that internet package tariffs have more than doubled since January 2025, in some cases doubling or tripling, alongside degradation of service. The account is the association's own. No regulator tariff series, operator price schedule or basket measure appears anywhere on this ledger, so the direction is reported by the party least likely to understate it and there is nothing to test it against. Read beside it, the satellite alternative is also out of reach on cost, reported under satellite broadband, and the network people are paying more for is the one the regulator itself describes as degraded.	REGRESSED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	National fibre backbone	1,750 km on the national backbone covers all provinces, with the regulator stating the national territory is now covered by fibre. Regulator statistics as at 31 December 2024 give fibre deployment by infrastructure operator: 1,750 km on the national backbone covering all provinces, 350 km of metropolitan network in the capital and 3,400 km on a third operator's network, and state that the national territory is now covered by fibre optic. 2026-04 — a presidential decree appointed a new director general of the mixed-economy company holding the backbone concession, and a second decree four days later named the administrators representing the state on its board. Governance moved; no traffic, utilisation or wholesale-price figure for the backbone is published, so what the fibre carries cannot be read from the base.	MOVEMENT
Connectivity	International internet bandwidth	International capacity runs through neighbouring countries' submarine landings; no capacity figure is published. The regulator's indicators report records submarine cable access to EASSy, SEACOM and TEAMS through neighbouring countries, cross-border fibre interconnection points with Rwanda, the Democratic Republic of the Congo and Tanzania, and regional roaming. For a landlocked country the international bandwidth position is its neighbours' landings and the transit bought over them. What the base does not hold is any capacity figure in Gbps, any wholesale transit price, or any statement of redundancy — which is the part that matters, since a single cross-border route is a single point of failure for the whole country's international traffic. Capacity on the Tanzanian route was agreed to rise from 4Gbps to 10Gbps, reported 9 September 2026 (capacity).	NO CHANGE
Connectivity	Internet Exchange Points	The exchange created by decree in 2014 carries nine members and 26 Gbps of cumulative capacity, unchanged over the last twelve months. The instrument is old: a national internet exchange point was created by decree in May 2014, its first objective keeping local traffic off international links. 2026-08 - what it amounts to twelve years on is now on the record: nine member networks and 26 Gbps of cumulative port capacity, with no network joining and none leaving in the last twelve months. Five members are registered in Burundi, three in the United States and one in the Netherlands - two content networks, two research networks, one service provider, one backbone operator at 10 Gbps, a route server and two unclassified. The security and measurement markers are absent: four of the nine peer at the route server, five hold valid routing-origin authorisations, the exchange is in no routing-security programme and hosts no measurement anchor. No traffic figure is published at any date, so how much local traffic actually stays local is not something this base can state.	NO CHANGE twelve months with no member joining or leaving
Connectivity	Satellite broadband licensing and availability	Satellite broadband is licensed but effectively unavailable on cost, the kit alone at roughly US\$500, unchanged through the window. The service is licensed and effectively unavailable on price, with the terminal alone at roughly US\$500. That was the position at the start of the window and nothing has moved it since: no tariff change, no subscriber figure, no second satellite operator and no regulatory statement appears. It is the only alternative to a mobile network that the regulator describes as failing mainly on electricity, and it is priced beyond the population it would serve. No universal-service subsidy, terminal financing or institutional purchase of satellite capacity is on the ledger.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (all providers)	No shared government data centre exists and capacity is being added one agency at a time, a development agency tendering for its own racks. A country diagnostic records that no shared government data centre exists, that the revenue office, the central bank and the presidency each run their own, that the backbone company hosts a national data centre other public agencies use for backup, that it operates one level-3 data centre built for USD 2 million, and that there are only about four data centres of decent grade in the country. 2026-02 — a development agency published a full national open tender for data centre racks, stabilisers and projectors with technical specifications and quantities. It is concrete in-window procurement of physical capacity, and it is for one agency's own facility rather than for a national one — which is the pattern the diagnostic described six years earlier and nothing since has changed.	MOVEMENT agency by agency
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (national providers)	A national data centre is named a mid-term priority of the World Bank programme, with no build, site or date on file. The data centre is named as a mid-term priority alongside public-finance modernisation and the national identity card. No build, site, capacity or date appears, and no baseline was held before it. It is the only data centre of any kind on this ledger — no commercial facility, no colocation provider and no hosting arrangement is recorded for the country. The sovereign cloud pillar of the artificial-intelligence strategy is built around this facility, so a strategy adopted in April 2026 depends on a building that has not been started.	NO CHANGE
Data Storage	Off-site backup capacity	The central bank maintains a physically separate alternative site, and the state technology body is procuring virtualisation and backup equipment. 2025-11-19 — the central bank issued an international tender for maintenance works on its alternative site, financed from its own funds. It is the clearest evidence that a physically separate secondary site for continuity of critical systems exists and is being maintained rather than left dormant; the notice covers building works and states no IT capacity, rack count or replication arrangement. 2026-04 — a re-issued tender sought additional equipment and licences for virtualisation and backup at the state technology secretariat, the body hosting national platforms. Backup capacity for the government estate is therefore at procurement stage while the central bank's own is in service — the two ends of the same question, several years apart.	MOVEMENT
Energy	Sufficient energy and water for data centres	A 17 MW dam was commissioned in June 2026 and a substation now allows up to 50 MW into the capital's network, against outages that put industry on gensets. 2025-08 — a new transformer substation was connected to a 110 kV transmission line, allowing up to 50 MW to be injected into the capital's urban network, reported against continuing outages that left businesses paralysed, hospitals on generators and industry on costly generating sets. 2026-06-16 — a 17 MW hydropower dam was officially commissioned, completing a complex at 49.5 MW, built for USD 320 million, the largest generation addition in the window; a nationwide 30 kV network reinforcement contract was signed the following day. The base holds no data-centre power demand figure and no water statement at all, so what is recorded is the supply side improving rather than a measured sufficiency for digital loads.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Energy	Grid reliability	The regulator names power cuts, generator fuel and unstable supply first among six causes of degraded networks, with base-station powering only at study stage. 2026-08-03 — the regulator published its own diagnosis of degraded mobile and internet quality and named six causes: power cuts, generator fuel supply, unstable supply from the utility, urban bandwidth saturation, ageing transmission equipment and missing masts. That is unchanged in kind from the position a year earlier, when outages were attributed to power, fuel and foreign-exchange shortages. The response is a study. Powering of mobile base stations is at study stage with no instrument or programme, against a network the same regulator says fails mainly on electricity. The effect reaches the systems this report tracks: the electronic invoicing machines reported under revenue collection stop whenever the power does.	NO CHANGE
Energy	Rural electrification	Access stands at 25.9 per cent, 8 per cent on the grid and 17.9 per cent off it, with ten rural centres electrified in the year. The national energy compact records installed capacity of 204.882 MW and an access rate of 25.9 per cent, split 8 per cent on the interconnected grid and 17.9 per cent on decentralised solutions, against a target of 70 per cent access by 2030, a target of 300 mini-grids and USD 3.49 billion of financing need. 2026-07 — the rural electrification agency named ten rural centres electrified during its 2025-2026 year with works continuing at seven more, alongside maintenance of solar mini-grids and micro-hydro plants. Named sites rather than a connection count is what the record supports, and neither source publishes how many households were connected in the year — which is the figure a target expressed as a share of the population has to be read against.	MOVEMENT
Technical Capacity	Robustness of government hardware and software	A revenue platform entered service in August 2026 and a cross-government financial system went out to tender, over an estate last described in 2022. A project appraisal document describes the government's own estate: a government network providing about 55 public institutions with 2.5 Mbps broadband, a small network operations centre and data centre run by the state technology secretariat, fragmented ministry servers and no national data-exchange layer. No later restatement of that position is held. 2026-03 — a request for proposals opened for the design, supply and installation of an integrated public financial management system, the largest cross-government software replacement identified. 2026-08-04 — the revenue authority's digitalisation platform entered service, from which date all new taxpayer registration is made exclusively online. A production system going live is a stronger statement about robustness than any procurement notice, and it is the only one the window holds.	MOVEMENT
Technical Capacity	Local capacity to maintain, manage and develop government systems	A change-management workshop prepared administration teams to run the financial management system, against three named bodies stated to require technical assistance. The digital ministry, the state technology secretariat and the regulator are all stated to require technical assistance — the base's standing position on who can run what. 2026-04-07 — a change-management workshop began preparing public administration teams to adopt and run the integrated public financial management system, aligned to the programme budget and to the national long-range vision. The distinction worth keeping is that this is appropriation of a central state system by the people who will operate it, not its procurement; no staffing establishment, certification count or retention figure is published, so the base records an intention to build capacity and not the capacity itself.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cybersecurity	National cybersecurity readiness	Regional central bank governors flagged financial-system cyber risk as needing stronger common measures; no national instrument or common measure exists. 2026-07-27 — East African central bank governors flagged financial-system cyber risk as requiring stronger common measures. No common measure has been adopted and no baseline was held before it. That single regional mention is the whole of the country's cybersecurity record on this ledger. No national strategy, no law, no computer emergency response team, no agency and no reported incident appears — at a point when an instant payment system, an online tax platform and a biometric identity programme have all entered service or are about to.	NO CHANGE

DPI

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	National data exchange system	The government's own appraisal records fragmented ministry servers and no national data-exchange layer; the 2018 framework decree provides the basis and no platform runs on it. A project appraisal document records fragmented ministry servers with no national data-exchange layer — a statement of absence in the government's own financing document rather than a gap in the record, and the position has not been restated since. The 2018 national data framework decree is the legal basis that would carry such a layer: it defines administrative data, brings it into the dissemination regime and provides for making data available by electronic means. No platform operates on its authority, no data-sharing agreement made under it is held, and the cross-government information-systems concept that would specify one was presented for validation in December 2024 and not adopted.	NO CHANGE
Data Exchange	Use of digital id in other systems	Identity verification was extended across the supervised financial sector and made compulsory for every SIM, in both cases against a document rather than a register. 2026-01-30 — a central bank regulation and its implementing circular on customer identification, identity verification and know-your-customer extended documentary identity verification across the supervised financial sector. It does not make the national identity card the exclusive document and describes no query against a central register. 2026-06 — the regulator required every subscriber to regularise SIM identification against the national identity card, with non-compliant lines deactivated from 25 June. Both are identity being consumed as paper. The payment-infrastructure assessment states the position underneath: national identity cards are presented as documentary evidence at account opening rather than authenticated against a register.	MOVEMENT documentary only

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	Interoperability of health systems	Common standards were defined in April 2026 naming HL7 FHIR, and a laboratory system went into nine sites with automated transmission. The health sector digital plan records that the reporting platform, the clinical system and the logistics applications coexist without automatic transfer, that feeding between them is manual, and sets normalisation, a unique identifier, software certification and interoperability as objectives to be built. 2026-04-07 to 10 — a national workshop defined common technical standards, notably HL7 FHIR, priority data-exchange flows and mediation for the fragmented platforms. 2026-05-18 to 29 — a laboratory information system was deployed to nine strategic sites, interconnecting ten diagnostic instruments to a central web platform with automated data transmission, with a national trainer pool formed to replicate across 64 instruments. That is health data actually moving between machines, which the plan of 2019 said did not happen.	MOVEMENT
Data Exchange	Interoperability of education systems	Ministry cadres were trained in database administration and the system was assessed against continental norms, from a paper-collection baseline. An independent assessment describes the education system's data chain as paper collection at the school followed by electronic entry at central level, published through the statistical yearbooks, with limits on integration and reliability of the databases. 2026-06 — cadres of the education ministry were trained in database administration as part of modernising the management information system, and Burundi self-assessed the system against the continental EMIS norms and standards at a three-day technical workshop, the most directly interoperability-facing education movement in the window. What neither states is a connection to anything outside education: no link to civil registration, to the identity register or to any other sectoral system is on the record.	MOVEMENT
Data Exchange	Interoperability of social protection systems	More than a million beneficiary records were migrated to a shared platform connected to several payment providers, with extension to the unified registry prepared. A technical policy note describes the position reached: the programme's management information system migrated to a shared platform, hosted in the government data centre, with modules in operation and an interfacing architecture that supports integration with identity databases — but does not confirm a live link to civil status or the national identity system. 2026-01 — more than a million individual beneficiary records were migrated, the system connected to several payment providers, and its extension to the unified social registry prepared. The connection this system has made is to payments; the connection it has not made is to identity, which is the one that would let it verify who it is paying.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Robustness of system	The biometric identity card was presented as technically ready in May 2026 and is waiting on the law or decree governing its use, piloted in about a dozen communes. 2026-05-07 — the card was presented as technically ready and awaiting the legal instrument governing its use, having been piloted in about a dozen communes. The starting position was a confirmation that it would not be ready for the 2025 voter enrolment. Whole-project cost is put at about BIF 15bn covering equipment, production centres and nationwide deployment, and BIF 16.0bn was proposed in the following year's draft budget. The order is deliberate: the government states that the data protection law came first in order to enable the card. What is still missing is the card's own instrument, an issuance figure and any statement of what it authenticates against.	MOVEMENT
Digital Identity and CRVS	Registration of entire population	83.5 per cent of under-fives were registered at the last national survey; thirteen communes now hold a biometric registration system. The third demographic and health survey puts 83.5 per cent of children under five registered with the civil-status authority, 83.7 per cent of boys and 83.3 per cent of girls, reported against the sustainable development goal indicator. It is the primary national statistical publication of the figure and it is now nine years old. 2026-08-10 — the territorial administration directorate set out digitalisation of civil status in pilot communes with decentralisation to zone level, and a UN agency stated that thirteen communes already have a biometric registration system. What has not been published is any updated national coverage rate, so the base can date the machinery and not the population it has reached.	MOVEMENT
Digital Identity and CRVS	National maintenance of id and credentials systems	Travel-document production is stated to be assured entirely by ministry staff since a foreign supplier's contract expired. The interior ministry records that travel-document production is assured one hundred per cent by the migration directorate's own staff since the expiry of the contract with a foreign supplier, a new supplier providing consumables only. It is the clearest official statement on this ledger that a credential system is nationally operated rather than vendor-run, and it is the ministry's own. What it does not carry is a volume, a backlog figure or any statement about the identity card as distinct from the passport — so the claim covers travel documents and cannot be extended to the credential estate as a whole.	NO CHANGE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Authentication	A border system reads and verifies passports at the international airport against international police databases, the first authentication on the ledger. 2025-08 — a border management system was launched at the international airport, automating reading and verification of passports with a direct interconnection to international police databases, announced for progressive extension to other border posts. It is the first instance on this ledger of a credential being checked against anything rather than simply read. What it authenticates against is a foreign database, not a Burundian one. The domestic position is that national identity is presented as documentary evidence rather than authenticated against a register, and no extension of the border system beyond the airport is recorded.	MOVEMENT one border post

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Digital id from birth	The civil registry's link to health facilities now runs in 123 facilities and has recorded more than 52,000 births, on the interior ministry's own count. 2026-08-11 — the civil-registry to health-facility link for birth registration, piloted since 2023 and institutionalised in 2024, is stated to run in 123 health facilities and to have recorded more than 52,000 births. The figures are the ministry's own and no coverage denominator is given, so the share of births captured is not knowable from the record. A national unique identifier is planned with fingerprint and facial biometrics, which would be the link from registration at birth to a credential. Nothing states when, or how a child registered through a health facility today obtains one.	MOVEMENT
Digital Identity and CRVS	Interoperability of birth registration and digital id	The country's own account states civil registration is not yet interoperable with the future digital identity; interoperability with health facilities is planned. 2026-07 — Burundi's country presentation to the African registrars general meeting states the position plainly: paper-based and manual elements persist, there is no single national civil-status database, and civil registration is not yet fully interoperable with the future national digital identification system. 2026-08-10 — the territorial administration directorate set out planned interoperability with health facilities for births and deaths, with notification through hill chiefs, alongside a national digital identity carrying a unique identifier and biometrics. The two accounts a month apart give the shape of it: the link is designed and not built, and the register it would connect to does not yet exist as a single database.	MOVEMENT
Digital Identity and CRVS	Use by other systems	There is no central national identity database able to support digital know-your-customer; identity is consumed as a document, not as a query. A payment-infrastructure assessment records that the national identity system is non-biometric and that there is no central national identity database able to support digital know-your-customer, national identity cards being presented as documentary evidence at account opening rather than authenticated against a register. It distinguishes identity interoperability from the payment switch, which does exist. That is the position the whole of this chapter rests on. Every system that requires identity in the window — the financial sector's customer identification rules, compulsory SIM registration, social protection enrolment — verifies a piece of paper, because there is nothing to ask.	NO CHANGE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Governance role of central bank	The central bank migrated the payment switch to the international messaging standard and issued five anti-money-laundering circulars. 2026-02-05 — the payment switch was migrated to the ISO 20022 messaging standard, from a position of not being migrated. It is the technical precondition for the instant payment system launched two months later and for the regional accessions reported under cross-border functionality. 2026-02-16 — five central bank circulars on anti-money-laundering and counter-terrorist financing were issued, aligned to the international standard-setter's recommendations, where no baseline was held. Both are the bank acting as scheme owner rather than as supervisor: no oversight report, scheme rulebook or published sanction appears on this ledger, and the mandatory-integration penalty reported below is the only enforcement instrument on record.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	G2P functionality	Social transfers reach recipients over their own mobile phones, and the beneficiary system is now connected to several payment providers. 2025-09 — a cash-transfer programme closed in one province after two years, having paid 73,600 BIF every two months over recipients' own mobile phones, 72,000 BIF net of the withdrawal charge. It is the clearest record the base holds of a government-to-person digital channel reaching a specific population, and the withdrawal charge is the part worth keeping: the recipient pays to take the money out. 2026-01 — the successor system migrated more than a million individual beneficiary records and was connected to several payment providers, which is the structural change: payment routed through a system rather than through one programme's arrangement.	MOVEMENT
Digital Payments and Fintech	Revenue collection	The online tax platform took over all new taxpayer registration from 4 August 2026, while invoicing machines stop with every power cut. 2026-01-19 — the online tax platform launched for declaration and payment, reported at the time as the country's first. 2026-08-04 — all new taxpayer registration became exclusively online through it, for natural and legal persons and cooperatives, with commercial registration routed through the business agency's portal, cooperative registration through the cooperatives agency, and biometric enrolment for natural persons. 2025-12-25 — the revised finance law requires banks to transfer telepaid taxes daily, with a penalty of 100% of the amount collected for missing the deadline. Against it, 2026-08-20 — traders in one province report that electronic invoicing machines stop working whenever the power does, halting sales and invoice issuance with every outage, with operators of weak literacy or digital skills reported to struggle. Delivery had stood at 500 of 10,000 machines ordered. No national outage figure, downtime measure or offline-mode provision is published.	MOVEMENT with the invoicing machines stopping whenever the power does
Digital Payments and Fintech	B2B and B2G functionality	A national instant payment system launched in April 2026 with interoperability across banks, microfinance and payment institutions. 2025-09-18 — managers of public funds were required to obtain an electronic-billing-machine invoice from suppliers before payment, on pain of a 20 per cent penalty — a digital control placed inside the government-to-supplier payment cycle. 2026-04-23 — the national instant payment system was launched, built under the World Bank-supported foundations project and providing full interoperability between commercial banks, microfinance institutions and payment institutions. The central bank reports annually on the clearing house, the real-time gross settlement system, the national switch and electronic money, so a series exists; no transaction volume or value for the new instant system is yet published.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	P2P, P2G and P2B functionality	The national instant payment system launched in April 2026 and had 17 of 78 licensed institutions live by August, with the four mobile-money systems interoperable. 2026-04-23 — the national instant payment platform launched publicly, connecting banks, microfinance institutions and mobile money on the international messaging standard and USSD at around 1,000 transactions per second, reported as Africa's twenty-second live instant payment system. 2026-08-06 — 17 of 78 licensed institutions were in production by 4 August 2026 — five commercial banks, ten microfinance institutions and two payment institutions — with about 224,000 users and cumulative transaction volume of about BIF 4.29bn, and integration mandatory for all licensed institutions by 5 September 2026 under a penalty of BIF 1m per month of delay. 2026-06-12 — the four mobile-money systems are named as interoperable through it, where they had not been. Fewer than a quarter of licensed institutions are live four months after launch, which is what the September deadline and its penalty exist to change.	MOVEMENT
Digital Payments and Fintech	Population uptake	Cash held about 45% of digital-payment value, with about 1.6m of 7.6m mobile wallets active in the last reading the base holds. 2025-09-29 — central bank data for the second quarter of 2025 put deposits and withdrawals at about 45% of digital-payment value and about 1.6m of 7.6m mobile wallets active. No baseline preceded it and no reading has followed it. The dormancy rate is the finding: roughly four in five wallets opened are not in use, which bounds what the instant payment system reported above can reach. Its own user figure of about 224,000 sits against those registered wallets. No quarterly series, no account-ownership survey and no financial-inclusion strategy appears anywhere on this ledger.	NO CHANGE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Cross-border functionality	The central bank acceded to the pan-African settlement system with four banks authorised and expects to join the East African payment system by December 2026. 2026-08-06 — the central bank has acceded to the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System, with four Burundian banks authorised to participate as at 4 August 2026. The accession date itself is not stated, only that it has occurred, and the continental trade secretariat discussed the system as an implementation instrument during its August mission. 2026-08-19 — the bank told the region's monetary affairs committee it expects to be inside the East African Payment System by December 2026, having migrated its settlement infrastructure to the international messaging standard, and has begun connecting domestic banks, the post office and the central bank to the COMESA regional payment and settlement system through technical training. Regional acceleration of the payment system was pressed at the July governors' meeting. Two accessions and one expectation, with no go-live date, participant list or transaction volume published for any of them.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Consumer protection	The regulator ordered an operator to make value-added-service subscription genuinely voluntary, and the consumer association reports no significant improvement two months on. 2026-07-24 — injunctions were issued requiring genuinely voluntary subscription to value-added services and prior notification of subscribers, where no such instrument existed. The consumer association reports no significant improvement two months on, no sanction is on file, and the operator maintains that nothing activates without a customer's deliberate action. It is the only enforcement action of any kind on this ledger, and it came from the telecommunications regulator rather than from the data protection authority the January 2026 law creates, which is not on record as operating. Nothing states how many subscribers were charged, or whether any money was refunded.	MOVEMENT an injunction with no sanction and no reported improvement
Registries	Population register	The national identification file has an administrative procedure page and no instituting instrument; further texts remain to be adopted. The official administrative procedure page for the Fichier National d'Identification and the national identity card states that further texts remain to be adopted to institute the file. A population register that issues a card without an instrument constituting it is the position this row records, and it is the reason every identity question in this report resolves to a document rather than to a database. The page itself carries no date and served an expired security certificate when it was captured, which is a small fact about how much of this estate is maintained.	NO CHANGE the instituting texts remain unadopted
Registries	Civil register	Biometric enrolment is operating in 13 pilot communes and decentralised to zone level, with 84% of under-fives registered but 66% holding a certificate. 2026-08-13 — biometric enrolment for the digital civil registry is operating in 13 pilot communes and has been decentralised to zone level, against a starting position in which the platform had been presented, every citizen was to re-register afresh and a family-code amendment was required. 2026-08-11 — coverage was stated on Africa Civil Registration Day: 84% of under-fives registered at birth and 66% holding a birth certificate, on a survey whose date is not given. The eighteen-point gap between registration and certificate is the finding, and it is the gap a digital registry is supposed to close. The ambitions and constraints of the programme were set out in May. No national rollout timetable beyond the pilot communes is published.	MOVEMENT
Registries	Address register	An urban property-owner census began building a geo-referenced register with a unique identifier per parcel, over postal address formats. An international addressing country file gives the national postal address formats — the whole of what the base held on addressing. 2026-07-14 — an urban property-owner census was launched to build a digitised, geo-referenced land register with a unique identifier per parcel, interoperable with other national registers and feeding a web mapping service and future digital land titles, first phase covering three communes of the capital and three towns, at about 3 billion BIF, with enumeration in August and September 2026. It is an address register arriving as a property register, which is a different object: it will number parcels and their owners rather than places, and no plan to extend it beyond the six urban areas is stated.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Business register	The commercial register is established in the 2015 code, and the historic manual stock is being converted onto a digital platform. Title V of the commercial code establishes the registre de commerce et des societes and the tax identification register and names the holding agency — the statutory basis, in force since 2015. 2026-06 — the development agency extended the window for persons and companies recorded under the old manual register to re-register free of charge on the digital platform. That operation is what converts a historic paper stock into a digital register, and an extension is what happens when it is going slowly; no count of firms re-registered, no total on the old register and no closing date for the manual one is published.	MOVEMENT
Registries	Social protection register	The unified social registry holds 249,671 households against a target of 290,000, across all 3,044 collines and quartiers. The unified social registry and its management system are the foundation of the national social protection system, reused by two named programmes. 2026-06-16 — the national social protection commission put the state of the registry on its own oversight agenda at its ninth annual general assembly, alongside the programme and the 2024-2033 national policy. 2026-06-30 — the modernised system is deployed in the government data centre and 249,671 households are recorded against a final target of 290,000, with coverage extending to all 3,044 collines and quartiers. It is the most completely reported register on this ledger: a count, a denominator, a target and a host. 2026-09-07 - the obligation behind any future register is now on the record: an ordinance of 7 February makes acquisition of the medical assistance card compulsory, a scheme dating from 1984 and reformed in 2012. No enrolment count, card format, register or digital component is described, so what the base holds is the obligation and not a system.	MOVEMENT
Registries	Electoral register	Preparations for the 2027 electoral register are under way and contested, with opposition parties demanding suspension; no biometric card is in use. 2026-05-09 — opposition parties demanded suspension of the electoral commission's preparations for the 2027 register. No baseline was held before it and the substance of the objection is not resolved on the record. The biometric card that might have underpinned the roll is not in use: it was confirmed as unavailable for the 2025 enrolment and is still waiting on its governing instrument. So the register is being prepared on the old basis, under objection, while the credential intended to modernise it sits ready and unusable. No enrolment figure, audit or de-duplication statement is published.	MOVEMENT
Registries	Tax register	Registration exists but is not integrated with filing and payment, and the value-added tax threshold was reset from 1 July 2026. An international assessment records the register's position: taxpayer registration exists but is not yet integrated with the filing and payment modules, the revenue platform is phased to full operation around mid-2027, and about 13,000 electronic billing machines are deployed against a 40,000 target. 2026-07-01 — the value-added tax threshold was set at 25,000,000 BIF of taxable turnover under a statute of 30 June 2026, with invoicing from 1 July and monthly declaration by the fifteenth. A threshold change is a change in who the register must carry, which is the register question rather than the platform question, and no count of taxpayers on either side of it is published.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Land register	Land titles are digitised, with about 123,000 holders to be secured, and a mandatory electronic-title fee drew objections on cost and deadline. Land services were digitised on an integrated platform in June 2025, and 2026-06-12 — the minister's stock-take put about 123,000 title holders as those to be secured digitally. 2026-04-01 — an ordinance making the electronic land title fee mandatory drew objections on its cost and on the shortness of its deadline. No response, revision or enforcement figure has followed. It is the most complete register on this ledger and the only one charging the public directly to use it. No count of titles actually converted, no processing time and no dispute figure is published.	MOVEMENT with the mandatory fee contested
Sectoral management information systems	Health	The health supply-chain system reached all public and faith-based facilities, 956 in total with more than 2,000 users, from a partial rollout. 2026-06-26 — the electronic logistics management and medicine-exchange system reached all public and faith-based facilities: 956 facilities and more than 2,000 users, against a partial rollout at the start of the window. It is the most completely deployed sectoral system on this ledger by facility coverage. What is not published is what it produces: no stock-out rate, no order cycle time and no data-quality measure appears, so the record shows a system installed everywhere and nothing about whether the supply chain it manages improved. The other health system on the ledger is the civil-registry link running in 123 facilities, reported under digital identity from birth.	MOVEMENT
Sectoral management information systems	Education	A monitoring tool for technical and vocational training centres was validated on 7 August 2026, with no deployment date or centre count stated. 2026-08-07 — a digital tool for tracking the institutional performance of technical and vocational training centres in real time was validated, built by a youth organisation under a European Union-backed project. Nothing of the kind was held before it. No deployment date, centre count or custodian ministry is stated, so what exists is a validated tool without an owner. It is the only education system on this ledger: no school census platform, enrolment system, teacher registry or examination system appears for the country.	MOVEMENT
Sectoral management information systems	Social protection	The social transfer programme completed migration to an open-source insurance platform, covering 1.25m beneficiaries. Migration of the national social transfer programme onto the open-source insurance management platform completed, covering 1.25m beneficiaries, from a position of migration under way. That is the largest beneficiary base of any government system on this ledger. Nothing is published about how payments reach those beneficiaries, whether the platform connects to the civil registry being digitised in parallel, or what identity is used to enrol — three questions the instant payment system and the biometric card reported elsewhere would each bear on.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Justice	An offline case-digitisation platform was deployed with thirteen scanning kits across the courts and is now at end-of-project evaluation. Technical assistance to the justice sector covered archiving, computerisation of court registries and case management, with a judicial-statistics collection system, servers and training behind it. 2026-06-11 — terms of reference for the end-of-project evaluation give the clearest published account of what was actually deployed: an offline platform for digitising and classifying pending case files, with thirteen scanning kits, across the supreme court, the appeal courts, the high courts and the prosecution offices of the targeted provinces. Offline is the operative word. A case-management estate that does not connect its courts is a filing improvement rather than a system, and the evaluation being tendered is the point at which someone finds out which it became.	MOVEMENT
Sectoral management information systems	Tax	The revenue platform went into production on 4 August 2026 as the exclusive registration channel, and billing-machine enforcement moved from distribution to inspection. 2026-01-19 — the integrated digitalisation of internal-revenue management was officially launched. 2026-04-08 — the revenue office moved from distributing electronic billing machines to checking their use: over 13,000 machines distributed nationally, capital inspections finding machines unused and non-conforming invoices, and buyers without an invoice liable to a 20 per cent penalty. 2026-08-04 — the platform entered service, from which date all new taxpayer registration applications are made exclusively online, with three routes for natural persons, legal persons and cooperatives and a biometric appointment step. A system that becomes the only channel is the strongest form of adoption and the one with the most exposure: no uptime figure, throughput or fallback is stated.	MOVEMENT
Sectoral management information systems	Customs	The revenue authority's electronic single window entered production with a pharmaceutical-import module. 2026-02-19 — the electronic single window was put into production, carrying a module for pharmaceutical imports run with the medicines regulator. None existed before it. One module in production is the whole of the record. No clearance volume, processing time or trader count is published, and no other agency is stated to have joined. The window sits alongside the online tax platform reported under revenue collection, and nothing states whether the two exchange anything.	MOVEMENT
Sectoral management information systems	Land	A joint ministerial ordinance set the terms on which the secured electronic land title is acquired, under the amended finance law. 2026-02-06 — a joint ministerial ordinance set the terms on which the secured electronic land title is acquired, under article 142 of the amended finance law. It is the point at which digitisation of the land title moves from budget intent to an instrument that applies to a transaction. What is held is the ministry's announcement rather than the operative text, so the fee, the procedure and the register the title is issued against cannot be read. No count of titles issued electronically, and no connection to the urban property census building a parcel identifier, is on the record.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Other GovTech and e-Gov	e-government services	One-stop service desks are under operationalisation with archive management still largely manual, a paperless Council of Ministers is reported, and a finance system award is contested. 2026-07-31 — operationalisation of one-stop service desks is named in the civil-service ministry's reform programme, with the ministry itself stating that archive management is still largely manual and service digitisation unfinished. 2026-06-12 — a paperless Council of Ministers is reported as operating, with no instrument or date published. 2026-04-20 — the integrated public finance management system is under procurement at an envelope of about US\$30m, and the single-source award is contested by a non-governmental organisation. The allegations are reported and not established, and no primary from the organisation or the ministry is held. No count of services available online, no service catalogue and no usage figure appears anywhere for the country.	MOVEMENT on announcements rather than on a countable service estate

Digitalisation

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	ICT infrastructure for local government	A USD 10 million contract was signed to extend rural 4G and equipment was handed to governors and communal administrators, from a base of non-functioning networks. A country diagnostic records broadband deployment to commune level as achieved while the multiservice telecentre per commune and the intranet and e-government services were not, and describes the government network as not functioning effectively in most government units. 2026-03 — a USD 10 million contract was signed to extend 4G broadband in rural areas, co-financed 44 per cent by government and 56 per cent by the operator, tied to access to digital public services. 2026-08 — a development agency handed laptops, uninterruptible power supplies, printers and photocopiers to provincial governors and communal administrators, the most direct addition to equipment held by local government offices in the window. No count of communes reached by either is published.	MOVEMENT
Digitalisation of sub-national government	Digitalisation of local government records	A ministry platform is being built to collect data from the communes to central level, alongside a geo-referenced urban parcel register. A technical manual governs the communal land services and zonal land counters, covering institutional anchoring, premises, IT equipment, staffing and the handling of certificates and registers, including tablet-based collection and electronic production and archiving — the most technically explicit instrument the base holds for a record kept at commune level. 2026-03-12 — a workshop presented a platform under development to collect data from the communes up to central level across territorial administration, civil status, migration, public security, cooperatives and disaster management, with a pilot scheduled for May 2026 and over a thousand users to be trained; participants named internet availability and infrastructure as the constraints. 2026-07-14 — an urban property-owner census began building a digitised, geo-referenced register with a unique identifier per parcel.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural health clinics	A laboratory system went into nine sites with automated transmission, and a mass campaign ran on digital household registration and barcode scanning. 2026-05-18 to 29 — a laboratory information system was deployed to nine strategic sites, interconnecting ten diagnostic instruments to a central web platform with automated data transmission, with a national trainer pool formed to replicate across 64 instruments. The 2025 insecticide-treated-net mass campaign was run on digital household registration and stock management with barcode and QR scanning and real-time tracking, the account carrying the challenges met and the lessons drawn as well as the design. Both are digital capture reaching where patients are rather than reporting from where they were seen. Neither states how many of the sites are rural, which is the question this indicator asks and the record does not answer.	MOVEMENT
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural primary schools	Tenders opened for digital centres at ten rural and peri-urban learning centres and 585 computers across 39 central schools. An independent assessment describes school data as paper collection at the school followed by electronic entry at central level, with no demonstrated direct electronic capture at rural fundamental schools. 2026-06 — a tender opened for IT equipment and the operationalisation of a multimedia centre, digital centres and distance-learning platforms for a polytechnic training centre and ten rural and peri-urban learning centres, and for computers and tablets for data collection. 2026-08-11 — a national request for proposals opened for computer equipment in 39 central schools in three former provinces, its bill of quantities naming 585 computers and uninterruptible power supplies. Both are procurement rather than delivery: no installed count, no connectivity provision and no maintenance arrangement is stated for either.	MOVEMENT
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural registry offices	A digital civil-registration platform is piloted in a first group of communes, with thirteen communes stated to hold a biometric system. 2026-05-06 — the interior ministry presented a digital civil-registration platform and biometric national identity card production, piloted in a first group of communes with intended extension to zone level. 2026-08-10 — the same directorate set out digitalisation in pilot communes and decentralisation to zone level, with planned interoperability with health facilities for births and deaths notified through hill chiefs, and a UN agency stated that thirteen communes already have a biometric registration system. Thirteen communes is the only number on the record. Burundi has well over a hundred, so what is established is a pilot that has been running for at least a quarter and a national position that has not moved.	MOVEMENT
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural police stations	A centralised geolocated police platform is reported under build with the pilot not yet launched; no provincial post is named. A centralised, geolocated data platform is reported under build for the national and judicial police: real-time checking of licences, insurance and roadworthiness, a geographic information system for patrol tracking and intervention analysis, and interconnection between police, transport, insurers, revenue and telecoms, with a pilot still to be launched. It is the only entry the base holds on police data capture. The source names no commissariat or police post in the provinces, so whether any of this reaches a rural station is not established — which is the whole of what this indicator asks.	NO CHANGE a platform reported under build with no pilot launched

Technology

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Use of AI in government administration	No artificial-intelligence system was identified in operational use in Burundian public administration; data is described as under-used and often unfit for advanced analytics. A synthesis of country readiness assessments carries the analysis for Burundi: institutions produce more data but it remains largely under-used and often unfit for advanced analytics, and strengthening those foundations is set out as a precondition for reliable adoption. The finding is an evidenced absence rather than a gap in the record, and it is the more useful of the two. It also explains the shape of the rest of this chapter: the one artificial-intelligence deployment the base holds sits inside a health workflow run with an external partner, not inside an administration.	NO CHANGE
AI	Use of AI in sectoral management information systems	A malaria diagnostic tool entered pilot in two provinces, and work is under way on a national malaria data warehouse. 2024-10 — a development agency, the health ministry and the malaria programme introduced an artificial-intelligence reading of malaria rapid diagnostic tests, with a demonstration workshop and a pilot in two provinces. It is the one evidenced case of artificial intelligence in operational use inside a Burundian sector workflow. 2026-03 — work with the health ministry, the malaria programme, the health information directorate and the sector's IT directorate is building a national malaria data warehouse, with the diagnostic tool described as still at pilot stage. Two years on, still a pilot. The warehouse is the more consequential half: a sectoral data layer is what a model would have to run on, and it is the thing the readiness assessment says is missing.	MOVEMENT
AI	Development of national / regional AI systems	Two local artificial-intelligence builds were named at a July 2026 workshop, with no funding, user base or public deployment on file. 2026-07-27 — two local builds were named at a governance and data ethics workshop, where nothing had been held before. No funding, user base or public deployment is recorded for either. They are the whole of the country's artificial-intelligence production on this ledger, against a strategy validated three months earlier that names innovation and incubators as one of its six pillars and about fifteen health and agriculture pilots. None of those pilots has been reported as starting, and no national computing capacity exists for any of them to run on.	MOVEMENT
AI	Control of AI abuse	The only governance activity on record is one workshop, run by an alumni association rather than a regulator, whose finding was that the country holds information rather than usable data. 2026-07-27 — the first documented workshop on artificial-intelligence governance and data ethics was run by an alumni association rather than by a regulator, and found that the country holds information rather than structured, consented, usable data. No supervisory authority, code of practice, procurement rule or incident is on record. The national strategy names governance and ethics as its first pillar and no instrument has followed it, so the position is unchanged: the ethics of automated decision-making are being discussed by volunteers, and the data protection authority that would have jurisdiction has not been constituted.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
ICT Industry	National capacity in DT-related production	A Burundian company is reported to have built and deployed a crop-disease diagnosis tool covering 37 diseases across seven crops. A Burundian company is reported to have built and deployed a machine-learning crop-disease diagnosis and prediction tool covering 37 diseases across seven crops. It is taken as evidence of national capacity in digital-technology production — a domestically built software product — rather than as evidence of artificial intelligence inside a government system, which is recorded separately and is absent. The account is a single trade report whose own two date lines disagree; no user count, revenue figure, accuracy measure or independent evaluation is held, so what the base can state is that the capacity exists and not how widely it is used.	MOVEMENT
Innovation ecosystem	Technology hubs	A hub reports incubating a programme targeting 40,000 entrepreneurs across two cities, and government published an account of a national digital festival. A field-based mapping of the entrepreneurship and innovation sector lists hubs and support organisations with a gap analysis, and is explicitly not an exhaustive register — so no national hub count can be taken from it, and none exists elsewhere in the base. 2026-02 — a hub set out its own incubation role in a national programme run with government, a development agency and three financing bodies, targeting 40,000 young and women entrepreneurs, with facilities in two cities. Self-published, so the reach is the hub's own claim. 2026-06-24 — a national digital festival was opened by the finance and digital economy ministry, organised with a professional centre and the World Bank project — a government account of a hub-run event, which is the firmer of the two records.	MOVEMENT
Innovation ecosystem	Tech startup ecosystem	A business-plan competition opened to small enterprises with the digital economy among its priority sectors, from a base of no venture or angel finance. A country diagnostic states digital entrepreneurship is embryonic, with one tech hub and no venture capital or angel finance. 2026-03-16 — a World Bank-financed project launched a business-plan competition supporting micro, small and medium enterprises, with information technology and the digital economy among the priority sectors. It is the largest in-window support and finance mechanism reaching Burundian startups and it is not startup-specific, which is itself the finding: the country has no startup act, no dedicated fund and no incubator financing line on this ledger. No award, cohort size or committed amount has been published against the competition.	MOVEMENT

Capacity

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (civil service)	A change-management workshop prepared administration teams to run the financial management system, against a component with no target or certification stated. The shared-infrastructure component of the national foundations project states that all its activities include targeted awareness initiatives and digital-skills training, principally for government officials who use, manage and maintain the shared infrastructure. No target number, obligation or certification is stated. 2026-04-07 — a change-management workshop began preparing public administration teams to adopt and run the integrated public financial management system, which is the first named cohort the base holds rather than a component description. Still no establishment figure, completion count or certification standard, so the base can record that training happens and not how many officials can use the systems being bought.	MOVEMENT
Literacy	Digital literacy (general population)	A national component finances awareness, device access and digital culture with no population baseline, instrument or numeric target stated. The national digital-inclusion component finances activities to raise awareness, increase access to broadband-capable devices and develop digital culture, targeting rural communities, women and girls, and vulnerable groups. It states no population digital-literacy baseline, no measurement instrument and no numeric target. That is the whole of the record. A programme with no baseline cannot report progress, and nothing else in the base measures population digital literacy — so the indicator is answered by a description of intent, and will stay that way until something counts.	NO CHANGE
Training and skills	DT-related training in secondary education	49 central-school computer centres were equipped against a 760 target; a first open-educational-resources strategy was validated in April 2026. The education ministry's own figure is 49 central-school computer centres equipped and all functional, against a stated target of 760 school networks — the clearest measure of the gap on this ledger, and it is the ministry's own. 2026-04-15 to 16 — a first national strategy on open educational resources was validated by acclamation, giving the country a framework for producing and distributing digital teaching materials across the fundamental and post-fundamental system, framed as digitising accumulated physical materials. 2026-08-11 — a request for proposals opened for 585 computers and uninterruptible power supplies across 39 central schools in three former provinces. Against 760, thirty-nine schools is the increment the window records.	MOVEMENT
Training and skills	DT-related university facilities and qualifications	Vietnamese cooperation delivered 50 desktop computer sets and Master's scholarships in computer science, against scholarships previously offered and undelivered. 2026-07-28 — 50 desktop computer sets and Master's scholarships in computer science were reported delivered under the Vietnamese cooperation, against a starting position in which scholarships of up to US\$10,000 each had been offered with nothing delivered on record. It is the only tertiary provision on this ledger, and it is fifty machines and a handful of places abroad. No university department, laboratory, qualification or graduate count is recorded for the country, and the artificial-intelligence strategy's target of training more than a thousand officials has no programme behind it on the record.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Training and skills	Graduates entering DT ecosystem	203 computing-engineering graduates entered the labour market since 2018-2019, with 347 students enrolled in 2023-2024. The higher teacher-training school put 203 computing-engineering graduates on the labour market since 2018-2019, with 347 students in the computing sections in 2023-2024, 31 per cent of them women. It is the only supply-side count the base holds and it covers one institution. 2026-03-16 — a second national coding camp under a continental girls' coding initiative opened for girls selected from across the country, running to 30 March, in programming, digital innovation and leadership, explicitly to prepare them for the digital economy, implemented with three ministries. What neither carries is a destination: no placement rate, no count of graduates working in the sector, and no employer-side demand figure to read the 203 against.	MOVEMENT
Research institutions	Think tanks and academic departments contributing to DT policy	A first documented research workshop drew university lecturers, doctors, developers and students, with no funded programme behind it. 2026-07-27 — the first documented workshop on artificial intelligence and data drew university lecturers, doctors, developers and students. No baseline was held and no funded programme, research centre or academic department is named. One convening by an alumni association is the whole of the country's research contribution to digital policy on this ledger. The national strategy's education and research pillar names no institution, and no university programme, publication or advisory body appears anywhere for the country.	MOVEMENT

Inclusion

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Citizen feedback portals	A harmonised national complaints strategy was validated during 2025 and digital reporting platforms for gender-based violence were presented in April 2026. The regulator's free short code and physical suggestion boxes in operator agencies are the standing official feedback channel, and they are sectoral: telecoms consumers rather than a cross-government grievance route. 2026-02 — a harmonised national complaints-management strategy was drawn up and validated during 2025, alongside the ombudsman's 2025 caseload of 776 files analysed and treated. 2026-04-09 — a citizen-facing digital alert and case-management system for gender-based violence was presented, with an interventions-management system for the institutions involved. It is the first citizen-facing reporting platform the base holds for Burundi, and it is one subject: no general-purpose portal exists.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Citizen participation in policy	An open online consultation ran on a donor partnership framework, and a data governance strategy was validated with public, private and civil-society actors. The communal administration statute is the founding basis for participation: open communal meetings, consultation of the base for the communal development plan, and hill and quarter development committees. 2025-11-06 to 07 — a national validation workshop for the first data governance strategy followed a stakeholder engagement workshop that brought public, private and civil-society actors together to identify priorities. 2026-04-21 to 05-05 — an open online consultation on a donor partnership framework took views from civil-society organisations, non-governmental organisations, the private sector, academia and the media. It is the clearest instance in the window of an online consultation channel addressed to Burundians — and it was opened by an external body rather than by government.	MOVEMENT
Access to services	Gender equity	A national survey is the standing sex-disaggregated measure of access to financial and digital services; digital platforms against gender-based violence were built. The national financial inclusion survey is the standing sex-disaggregated measure of access to financial and digital financial services in Burundi, and the only recurring gender-disaggregated series the base holds on this subject. 2026-04-09 — the responsible ministry and a UN agency presented digital platforms built under a national gender-based-violence observatory project: a citizen-facing alert and case-management system through which victims report and are referred for assistance, plus an interventions-management system for the institutions involved, funded by the European Union. What is absent is any sex-disaggregated measure of digital access itself — of device ownership, internet use or digital skills — so gender equity is read here through financial services and through a violence-reporting tool rather than through the technology.	MOVEMENT
Access to services	Inclusion of persons with disabilities	The state's initial report to the disability rights committee sets out the statute, the policy, the national committee and the gaps in access to information technology. Burundi's initial report under the disability rights convention is the state's own comprehensive statement of position: ratification, the 2018 statute promoting and protecting the rights of persons with disabilities, the 2020-2024 national policy, the national committee, assistive devices, census data, and the gaps in access to services and to information and communication technology. It is a baseline and it is the state's own account, submitted nine years after it was due. Nothing else in the base measures digital accessibility: no website accessibility standard, no assistive-technology provision figure and no disaggregated access measure is held, so the position can be described and not tracked. An accessibility index puts a number on it: 17.5 out of 100 in 2020, 117th of 137 countries and 25th in the region, up from 15 out of 100 and 97th of 121 in 2018, with no policy recorded in any of its ten areas - web, television, mobile telephony, e-books, internet availability, inclusive education technology, employment technology, e-government, assistive technologies and accessible procurement. Its latest data year is 2020, so it predates the state's own report and cannot be read against it.	NO CHANGE an index unmoved on policy against a state report that states the gaps

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Inclusion of refugees and IDPs	Level-2 biometric registration of 54,343 Congolese refugees was completed at one site, and cash transfers reached refugees over their own phones. Asylum claims are recorded in an international agency database and claimants enrolled with fingerprint and iris biometrics, with a refugee identity card issued under the 2021 migration law — a registration system operated jointly by the national office and the agency. 2025-09 — a cash-transfer programme run by government, the World Bank and the food agency closed in one province after two years, having paid 73,600 BIF every two months over recipients' own mobile phones. 2026-07-06 — level-2 biometric registration of 54,343 Congolese refugees was completed at one site, stated as strengthening protection, improving data quality and better targeting assistance. The refugee population is more completely biometrically enrolled than the citizen population, which is the structural fact this indicator keeps recording.	MOVEMENT
Digital divides	Bridging of digital divides	The broadband programme targets 80% territorial coverage and carries a digital villages component, with no achieved figure on file. 2026-05-01 — the broadband programme is stated to target 80% of the territory, with a digital villages component under way and no completion date or coverage achieved on file. No baseline was held for either. What is measurable sits elsewhere in this report and cuts the other way: tariffs more than doubled, the satellite alternative costs more than most can pay, and the regulator says the network fails mainly on electricity. A territorial coverage target says where a signal reaches; none of the three says whether anyone can afford or rely on it. The divide the programme is aimed at has one measurement in this base and it is two years old: 1.51 million internet users at the start of 2024, 11.3 per cent of the population, against 7.78 million mobile connections equal to 58.0 per cent. The regulator's own later statement that very few Burundians use the internet carries no figure at all.	MOVEMENT on a target rather than on an achieved figure

Data

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	National strategy for development of statistics	A third-generation strategy is in force and its mid-term evaluation was reported to the statutory sector group in July 2026. The 2022 decree replacing the former institute with the national statistical authority charges its coordination department with elaborating and coordinating implementation of the national strategy for the development of statistics — the mandate in national law rather than in donor commentary. 2026-05-08 — a validation workshop was held for the national statistical system's communication and dissemination strategy, aligned to regional guidelines. 2026-07-28 — the statutory sector statistics group met with the recommendations of the third strategy's mid-term evaluation on its agenda, establishing both that a third-generation strategy is in force and that its mid-term evaluation has reported. Neither the strategy nor the evaluation is published, so the base can date the process and not read its findings.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	Censuses and surveys	The 2024 census published preliminary results by decree, enumerating 12,332,788 residents, with definitive results still to come. Burundi hosted an Equatorial Guinean delegation over 10-16 August 2026 to share its digital census experience under south-south cooperation (visit). 2025-03-27 — a decree published the preliminary results of the 2024 census for all purposes pending definitive results: 12,332,788 residents, 5,901,069 men and 6,431,719 women, with 9,255,195 rural against 3,077,593 urban, with the tables released by the statistics institute. The base's prior population figure was a projection off the 2008 enumeration. Definitive results have not followed in the seventeen months since, and the results are reported against the five provinces created by the 2023 territorial reform rather than the eighteen that preceded them, which breaks comparison with everything published before. No household survey, no statistics law and no national strategy for the development of statistics appears on this ledger.	MOVEMENT
National statistics	Statistics from administrative data	Two further sectoral yearbooks were published in the window, one from the annual school census and one built from a ministry's own records. The national statistical yearbook is described by the institute itself as a compilation, centralising figures otherwise dispersed across specialised publications and ministry annual reports — which is the administrative-data chain stated in the institute's own words. 2025-12 — an education yearbook was published for the 2024-2025 school year, produced from the annual school census, the clearest working example of official statistics drawn from an administrative source. 2026-01 — a trade, transport, industry and tourism yearbook was published, built entirely from the ministry's own administrative records: licences and permits issued, certificates of origin, import-export codes, port and airport traffic and technical-control certificates. Three yearbooks and no register-based statistics: the chain runs from paper forms to a book, not from a database to a series.	MOVEMENT
Open data	Use of open data	The statistics institute publishes an open licence permitting reuse, redistribution and derivative products, subject to attribution. The institute's open data platform carries a worldwide, free, non-exclusive licence to use, copy, modify, translate, publish, adapt, distribute and build derivative and value-added products from the data, for commercial and non-commercial purposes, subject to attribution. It is Burundi's operative open data licence and it is the whole of what the base holds on open data: one institution's platform, with no whole-of-government portal, no publication schedule, no dataset count and no measure of reuse. The page carries no date, so even the licence's age is a proxy from an archived capture.	NO CHANGE a first record of the licence with no earlier position behind it

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Use of satellite data	Agricultural use of satellite data	The national mapping producer names agriculture among the four purposes of Burundian cartography, and census mapping was cleaned using satellite imagery. The national mapping producer's own service page names agriculture as one of the four things Burundian cartography exists to do – identifying and managing agricultural, urban and protected areas – and states that mapping has modernised through remote sensing, satellite positioning, geographic information systems and drones, with a bilateral partnership updating two cities since 2009. 2026-02-09 – the census bureau opened a twenty-day workshop with the mapping institute to clean, verify and update the census cartography database, geoprocessing vector data and interpreting satellite imagery over administrative boundaries covering 3,044 collines et quartiers. The satellite use is real and it is cartographic. No crop-monitoring, yield-estimation or agricultural early-warning product built on satellite data is held.	MOVEMENT
Use of satellite data	Meteorological use of satellite data	A satellite imagery viewer publishes named geostationary layers on automatic update, and impact-based forecasting was launched in May 2026. 2025-09 – the automatic weather station network was connected to the international data exchange system for the first time, moving off the older network and beginning international transmission, including a backlog archived since 2022 that had sat unexploited on local servers. The same account is candid about why the network had been down: expired SIM cards, unpaid data plans and lack of basic maintenance. 2026-05-27 to 29 – impact-based forecasting was launched with the world meteorological organisation, to turn meteorological data into decision-ready information, a capability launch and staff training rather than a delivered product. The institute publishes a satellite imagery viewer whose named dynamic layers are geostationary precipitation, infrared and convection products, plus natural-colour imagery and a cloud mask, on automatic update.	MOVEMENT

Geopolitics

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
US / hyperscaler activities	USA / hyperscaler MoUs, engagements and commitments	A five-year United States health-sector agreement commits US\$156m and includes health-data management; no data-sharing agreement under it is published. 2026-02-09 – a five-year memorandum with the United States committing US\$156m to the health sector was signed, including health-data management, where nothing existed before. It is the only United States engagement on this ledger and the largest foreign commitment of any origin. No data-sharing agreement under it has been published, no implementing arrangement is named, and no disbursement has been reported in the six months since. No hyperscaler, cloud provider or American technology vendor appears anywhere in the record for the country.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
China activities	Chinese MoUs, engagements and commitments	A framework agreement was signed whose stated object is digital transformation of the mining chain, and equipment was handed to the state news agency. A satellite television project was handed over with 300 villages equipped, implementing a continental forum pledge and funded through a south-south cooperation fund — the most nearly primary record of a Chinese digital commitment to Burundi being delivered. 2026-05-28 — the ambassador visited the state news agency and handed over information technology and production equipment. Small in value, and the only Chinese digital or media-technology engagement in the window recorded by a Burundian official source. 2026-07 — a framework agreement was signed whose stated object is explicitly digital: digital transformation of the whole mining industry chain, data-driven exploration and detection technology, laboratory capacity and a digital platform connecting resources to markets. No text of any China-Burundi digital memorandum is publicly held, so the substance is known through the counterparty's own account.	MOVEMENT
EU activities	EU MoUs, engagements and commitments	A regional digital economy programme formally started covering Burundi, and three digital tools were handed to a ministry, against no bilateral digital priority. The bilateral programming instrument carries no standalone digital or data priority area for Burundi; digital appears transversally across the three priority areas — a negative finding, and the frame everything else here sits in. 2026-06-24 — a forum marked the formal start of a co-financed regional digital economy programme covering Burundi as one of eight partner states: digital transformation strategy, e-commerce, interoperable cross-border payments, e-government and cybersecurity. It is the most concrete European digital commitment reaching Burundi, and it reaches it regionally rather than bilaterally. 2026-07-14 — three digital tools were formally handed to the responsible ministry through a UN agency, with a vehicle, seventeen motorcycles and training for 47 officials and 13 managers.	MOVEMENT
Gulf/UAE activities	Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments	One engagement is documented: a Qatari holding group announcing intended investment in cybersecurity, digital transformation and telecommunications. The President received a Qatari delegation from a holding group, which announced intended investment in cybersecurity, digital transformation, telecommunications and banking. That is the only documented Gulf digital or data engagement the base holds, and the finding beside it is the more useful one: no Gulf-Burundi memorandum, framework agreement or loan specifically on digital or data was located. An announced intention by a private group, received at the presidency, is what stands in for a bilateral relationship here — no instrument, no value and no follow-up is on the record.	NO CHANGE one announced intention and no instrument
India activities	India MoUs, engagements and commitments	Talks opened on adapting an India Stack-style identity linked to instant payments, with nothing signed. 2026-06-23 — talks opened on adapting the Indian digital public infrastructure model, an Aadhaar-style identity linked to instant payments, reported again a week later and as a partnership on digital identity. Nothing has been signed. The fit is closer than most such talks: the country has an instant payment system live since April 2026 and a biometric identity card technically ready and waiting on its instrument, which are the two halves the model joins. No memorandum, technical assistance agreement or timetable has followed.	MOVEMENT

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Compute or high-performance computing capacity	A data-centre, cloud or high-performance computing specification, or a hosting contract for a public system.	2026-08-09
Digitisation of communal administration	A commune-level revenue or service system specification, or the instrument behind the communal-revenue digitalisation budget line.	2026-08-09
Earth-observation or satellite data programme	A national earth-observation or geospatial-data programme document, or an agency mandate covering satellite data.	2026-08-09
National technical standards or interoperability framework	A national interoperability framework, technical standard or e-government architecture document.	2026-08-09
Open government data portal	The text of the access-to-information bill, an open-data policy, or a public-sector data portal.	2026-08-09
European Union digital cooperation with Burundi	Any EU or European Investment Bank digital financing, programme or memorandum covering Burundi.	2026-08-09
Chinese digital investment in Burundi	Any Chinese financing, contract or memorandum covering Burundian digital infrastructure.	2026-08-09
Gulf-state digital investment in Burundi	Any Gulf-state investment, financing or memorandum covering Burundian digital infrastructure.	2026-08-09
Digital literacy programme or measurement	A digital-literacy programme document, or a published measurement of digital literacy.	2026-08-09
Data-sharing agreement under the United States health-sector memorandum	The data-sharing agreement itself, a signature date, or a Burundian government statement naming it. The memorandum of 2026-02-09 is held; on the United States government account each such memorandum carries at least one further data-sharing agreement, and those texts are withheld rather than unpublished, in litigation in the United States District Court for the District of Columbia	not yet probed
Rules restricting cross-border data transfer	A Burundian instrument imposing or lifting a restriction on cross-border data transfer, data location or local processing.	2024-01-04
Dedicated artificial-intelligence legislation	A loi, decret, ordonnance ministerielle or regulator reglement governing artificial intelligence.	2025-11-28
National data exchange layer	A specification, contract or operating record for a platform exchanging data between two or more Burundian public bodies.	2022-05-31
Consumption of the national identity by other systems	A described query from any system against a central Burundian identity register, or a statement that the register can answer one.	2025-04-01
Artificial intelligence in public administration	A named artificial-intelligence system in operational use inside a Burundian public administration, with the body running it.	2026-07-01

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